

Service in a Snap: Axe Yard Maintenance

Estimated Time: 60 Minutes

Who: Designated Scout (e.g., Patrol Quartermaster) or Adult Leader.

When: Semi-annually or before a multi-day camping event.

Impact: Ensures all wood-cutting tools are safe, sharp, and accounted for, preventing injury and enabling efficient campsite setup.

Requirements: Supports requirements for the Totin' Chip and Woodwork Merit Badge.

Reference:

- [Woodwork Merit Badge Pamphlet](#)
- Service in a Snap (Troop Google Drive)
- Inventory List on troop500.org

Your Mission

Inventory, clean, and maintain the tools in the Axe Yard Box to ensure they meet safety standards and are ready for troop use. This includes checking for rust, damage to handles, and tool sharpness.

Preparation

1. **Pick up the Gear:** Coordinate with Troop Quartermaster or Equipment Coordinator to collect the Axe Yard Box in either Trailer or Closet.
2. **Gather Supplies:** Paint markers, metal files, sharpening stones, light machine oil, cleaning rags, and disinfecting wipes.
3. **Set up Space:** Find a flat, well-lit surface to spread out the contents for inventory.

Step-by-Step Instructions

- **Step 1: Clean Out** – Completely empty the Axe Yard Box. Wipe down the interior of the container with cleaning supplies.
- **Step 2: Labelling** – Re-label any faded markings on handles or the box itself to ensure everything is returned to its correct place.
- **Step 3: Quality Check** – Inspect axe heads for rust and check handles for cracks or loose heads. Ensure all saws have proper tension and sharp teeth. Apply a light coat of oil to metal surfaces to prevent corrosion.
- **Step 4: Inventory** – Use the inventory sheet from the website to identify missing or damaged items.
- **Step 5: Restock** – Note any missing items to be replenished from the central equipment stores.
- **Step 6: Organize** – Re-pack the tools logically, ensuring heavy items are at the bottom and safety gear is easily accessible.
- **Step 7: Report** – Submit the completed inventory and status report to Troop Quartermaster and Equipment Coordinator

Notes:

Parent/Scout Name: _____ Date: _____

Troop Quartermaster: _____ Date: _____

Equipment Coordinator: _____ Date: _____